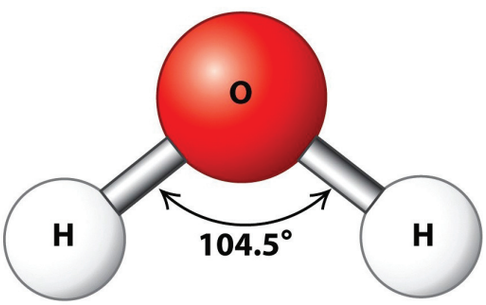


Figure 4.3: Application of rocket fuel

4.5 Compounds of Hydrogen

4.5.1 Water

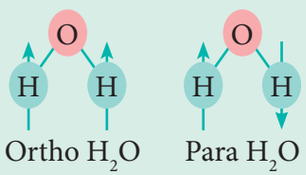
Water is one of the most abundant compounds of hydrogen and our earth's surface contains approximately 70 % of ocean which is the major source of water. However, sea water contains many dissolved salts hence it can not be used directly. Water is essential for all living things and our body contains about 65% water.





Ortho-H_2O and Para-H_2O

Water exists in the interstellar clouds and icy satellites of the solar system. In particular, the ortho-to-para ratio (OPR) of water in space has recently received attention. Like hydrogen, water can also be classified into ortho-H_2O, in which the spin directions of the nuclei of the hydrogen atoms are parallel, and para-H_2O, in which the directions are antiparallel. OPR of H_2(300K) on earth should be 3:1. OPR of H_2O(50K) in interstellar clouds and comets should be 2:5:1.



4.5.2 Physical Properties:

Water is a colourless and volatile liquid. The peculiar properties of water in the condensed phases are due to the presence of inter molecular hydrogen bonding between water molecules. Hydrogen bonding is responsible for the high melting and boiling points of water. Some of the physical parameters of water are listed in Table 4.2.

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